Vouch..

Your social life, *ranked.*

Product Specification — MVP v1.0 · New York City Pilot · March 2026

Rate everything. Trust your people.

Vouch is the social experience platform where your network's lived experiences guide what you do next — across every category of life in New York City.

OVERVIEW

Product Overview

Vision

Vouch is a social discovery platform for every kind of experience — restaurants, bars, concerts, fitness classes, museums, live sports, pop-ups, and anything else you can do in your city. Unlike category-specific apps (Beli for restaurants, Strava for fitness), Vouch is the single place to rate and discover anything, powered by the people you actually trust.

The core moat is social trust. When someone you follow vouches for something, that signal is worth more than a thousand anonymous reviews. Vouch makes that signal visible, searchable, and actionable.

MVP Scope

The MVP is a mobile-first web application, piloting exclusively in New York City. It ships with four core pages on a persistent bottom navigation bar:

- Feed — personalised discovery from friends and the Vouch algorithm, with the Discover bar at the top
- Search — find venues and events; log and rate your experiences; tag friends
- Map — NYC map of ratings, wishlists, and friend activity; Neighbourhood Guides by area
- Profile — your identity, ratings, lists, wishlist, streaks, and social network

> **Pilot Scope**
> New York City is the exclusive pilot market. All data, integrations, editorial content, and trending logic are scoped to NYC for launch. Geographic expansion is a post-MVP milestone.

Positioning

Dimension	Vouch Approach
Category breadth	Everything you can do, see, eat, or experience — not just restaurants
Trust layer	Friend-network ratings surface above algorithmic noise
Rating depth	Multi-dimensional scoring (Vibe · Value · Experience) gives nuanced signal

AI Discovery	Voice-first conversational discovery — 'I want to plan something for tonight in Brooklyn' — returns personalised, editorially reviewed recommendations
Cold start	Algorithm + editorial fills the feed before your network is built
Re-engagement	Email digests, streaks, leaderboards, and Side Quests drive habitual return

DESIGN SYSTEM

UI/UX & Design Language

All product design should extend the visual identity established at vouchxp.netlify.app. The landing page defines the tone, palette, and typographic system. Every screen in the app should feel like a natural continuation of that page.

Color Palette

Token	Usage
#E8572A — Brand Orange	Primary accent. Used for section labels, links, italic hero text, CTA text, left-border callouts, and any element that draws the eye. This is the brand's most expressive color.
#F5C842 — Brand Yellow	Score badges, the logo mark asterisk, and numerical ratings. The yellow communicates warmth and reward — it should appear wherever a score or achievement is displayed.
#1A1A1A — Primary Text	Near-black for all body copy and headlines. Never pure black (#000000). Warm and readable.
#9B9B9B — Secondary Text	Muted gray for timestamps, metadata, secondary labels, nav items, and any supporting copy that should not compete with primary content.
#F5F5F3 — Surface / Card Background	Very light warm off-white for cards, input fields, and elevated surfaces. Keeps the page feeling airy without being clinical white.
#E8E8E4 — Divider / Border	Used for horizontal rules, card outlines, table borders, and subtle separators.
#FFFFFF — Background	Page background. The app is light-mode first.

Typography

Type Role	Specification
Headline / Display	Georgia (serif). Used for page titles, section headings, and large display text. Reflects the editorial, taste-forward personality of the brand. Key headlines use italic weight in Brand Orange for emphasis — mirroring the landing page's 'Your social life, ranked.' treatment.

Body / UI	Inter or system sans-serif. Used for body copy, labels, buttons, form fields, navigation, and all functional UI text. Clean and neutral — lets the serif headlines breathe.
Score Display	Georgia, oversized (48–64px). Score numbers (8/10, 10/10) are a key UI element and should be displayed large, in Brand Yellow, as a visual anchor on listing and feed cards.
Section Labels	Arial or Inter, 11–12px, bold, all-caps, Brand Orange. Used above section headings as category markers — matching the 'YOUR TASTE PROFILE' and 'NETWORK DISCOVERY' labels on the landing page.
Metadata / Tags	Arial, 11–12px, Brand Orange or Secondary Gray. Used for category tags, timestamps, neighborhood labels, and status tags like RELIABLE / AVOID / TELL EVERYONE.

Design Principles

Principle	Guidance
Generous whitespace	The landing page breathes. Large margins, tall line heights, and unhurried spacing are non-negotiable. The app should feel calm, not cluttered.
Scores are the hero	Score numbers — displayed in Brand Yellow at large sizes — are the most important piece of data on any card or listing. Design around them, not around them as an afterthought.
Serif + sans-serif contrast	The tension between Georgia (warm, editorial) and Inter (clean, functional) is the brand's typographic personality. Maintain it throughout the app.
Orange as a highlighter	Brand Orange should appear sparingly and purposefully — on labels, links, accents, and interactive states. It is not a fill color. Overuse dilutes its impact.
Light mode first	The MVP launches in light mode only. Dark mode is a future consideration. The off-white (#F5F5F3) card surfaces keep the UI from feeling flat against the white background.
No unnecessary chrome	Avoid heavy borders, drop shadows, or decorative elements. The landing page's restraint is the standard. UI should feel like it gets out of the way of the content.

Score Display System

The Vouch Score is the brand's signature UI element. Score numbers should feel like they belong to the same family as the large '8/10', '4/10', '10/10' displayed on the landing page. The following conventions apply across all surfaces:

8	9	10
Vibe	Value	Experience
RELIABLE	**WORTH IT**	**TELL EVERYONE**

- Scores are displayed as a single integer (0–10), not a decimal, at the card level
- Full breakdown (Vibe / Value / Experience separately) shown on listing pages only
- Score color: Brand Yellow (#F5C842) at display size; Black at small/inline size
- Score labels (RELIABLE, AVOID, TELL EVERYONE) are in Brand Orange, all-caps, 11px bold
- Score label thresholds: 0–4 → AVOID, 5–6 → MEH, 7–8 → RELIABLE, 9 → GREAT, 10 → TELL EVERYONE

USER FLOWS

Onboarding

Authentication

Vouch supports two OAuth login methods. No password-based accounts at launch.

- Google OAuth 2.0
- Instagram Basic Display API

On first login, Vouch creates an account using the user's name, profile photo, and email from the OAuth provider. The user is taken immediately into the onboarding survey — no friction, no extra form fields.

Onboarding Survey

The survey is conversational, visual, and completes in under 90 seconds. It seeds the personalization engine and determines the initial feed composition. Survey responses are stored to the profile and can be updated at any time.

- Experience categories of interest (multi-select):
  - Food & Drink — restaurants, bars, cafés, pop-ups
  - Live Events — concerts, comedy, theater, DJ sets
  - Sports — live games, fitness classes, outdoor activities
  - Wellness & Fitness — pilates, yoga, rock climbing, pole, aerobics, boxing
  - Arts & Culture — museums, galleries, film screenings, exhibitions
  - Social Scenes — rooftops, nightlife, lounges, game nights
- NYC neighborhood(s) they frequent or want to explore
- Discovery preference — friends' picks, trending, or curated editorial

> **Cold Start Note**
> Survey responses directly seed the feed algorithm. Users who skip the survey see a generic trending-in-NYC feed until they complete it. A persistent nudge prompts completion from the profile page.

The Feed

Purpose

The Feed is the home screen and primary discovery surface. It surfaces what your network is doing and what Vouch recommends — filtered to NYC and your stated interests. It should feel like a curated, trusted stream — not an infinite scroll of algorithmic noise.

Content Types

Card Type	Description
Friend Activity Card	When someone you follow rates an experience. Shows venue name, their Vouch score (large, in Brand Yellow), score breakdown, review text, photos, and tags.
Vouch Pick	Algorithmic recommendation based on your survey preferences and rating history. Clearly labelled 'Vouch Pick' in Brand Orange.
Trending in NYC	High-velocity experiences gaining ratings across the network this week. City-wide signal, not personalized.
Upcoming Event	Time-sensitive events surfaced ahead of date with ticket link. Labelled 'Upcoming' with the event date prominent.
Wishlist Nudge	When a friend rates something you've saved to your wishlist, that card is promoted to the top of your feed.

Feed Ordering Logic

The feed uses a ranked blend of three signals, dynamically weighted:

- Friends' activity — highest weight. Recency + relationship strength. Mutual follows weighted higher than one-way.
- Trending in NYC — velocity of ratings in the past 7 days across the full Vouch network.
- Category match — alignment with onboarding survey preferences and personal rating history.

A horizontal chip strip at the top of the feed allows filtering by category (e.g. Fitness only, or Food & Drink only). No proximity/geo filter in MVP — NYC-wide by default.

Feed Card Anatomy

- Venue or event name + category tag (Brand Orange, all-caps, 11px)
- Vouch Score — large integer in Brand Yellow, the visual anchor of the card
- Friend attribution — avatar + name + their individual score breakdown
- Short review text (if written, max 280 chars)
- Photo strip (if uploaded, up to 3)
- User tags (e.g. 'great for dates', 'worth the hype') in Brand Orange
- Wishlist bookmark icon — tap to save
- Tap through to full listing page

Search & Rate

Purpose

The Search page is where users look up venues and events, log experiences, and submit ratings. It also serves as a browsing surface for users with active intent — 'I want to find something to do this weekend.'

Search UX

A universal text input searches across all experience types. Results are split into two tabs:

- Places — permanent venues (restaurants, gyms, museums, bars, etc.)
- Events — time-bound experiences (concerts, sports, classes, pop-ups)

Each search result card shows: name, category tag, address/neighborhood, aggregate Vouch Score in Brand Yellow, and a small avatars row of friends who have rated it. Tapping opens the Listing Page.

Listing Page

Element	Description
Header	Venue/event name (Georgia serif, large), category tag (Orange, all-caps), neighborhood, and external links (Google Maps, Eventbrite, Ticketmaster where applicable).
Vouch Score	The composite score displayed prominently in Brand Yellow at large size. Below it, a three-bar breakdown showing Vibe / Value / Experience averages separately.
Friends' Takes	Dedicated section showing ratings from people you follow — their score, breakdown, photos, review text, and tags. This is the social moat made visible.
All Reviews	Full list of Vouch ratings from all users. Sortable by Most Recent or Highest Rated.
Upcoming events	Date, time, ticket availability, and 'Get Tickets' external link.
Log Your Visit CTA	Prominent button opening the rating modal. Styled in Brand Orange.

Save to Wishlist	Bookmark icon in header or sticky footer.

Rating Modal

A structured modal guides the user through logging an experience:

Field	Description
Vibe	Atmosphere, energy, and feel. Score 1–10. Displayed with a large Brand Yellow numeral as the user drags/taps.
Value	Worth what you paid — time, money, effort. Score 1–10.
Experience	The core thing itself — the food, performance, class, or game. Score 1–10.
Photos	Optional. Up to 3 photos, max 5MB each.
Written Review	Optional. Max 280 characters. Concise and punchy.
Tags	Multi-select from curated tag bank: 'Great for dates', 'Bring cash', 'Worth the hype', 'Overhyped', 'Hidden gem', 'Good for groups', 'Come early', 'Book ahead'.
Visit Date	Auto-populated to today; adjustable for retroactive logging.

Score Formula

The Vouch Score shown on listings is the unweighted average of (Vibe + Value + Experience) ÷ 3, rounded to one decimal. Displayed as a single integer on cards; one decimal on listing pages.

Profile

Purpose

The Profile page is the user's public identity on Vouch — their taste, activity, and network. It is also the settings and account management hub.

Public Profile Elements

Element	Description
Name & Photo	Pulled from OAuth on sign-up. Editable.
Handle	Auto-generated from name; customizable (e.g. @jess_nyc).
Bio / Tagline	Optional, max 120 characters.
Stats Bar	Total experiences rated · Categories explored · Member since.
Followers / Following	Counts with tap-through to list views.
Top Categories	Auto-generated from rating history — the 3 categories with most activity.
Recent Ratings	Grid of most recent ratings with Brand Yellow score chips.
Wishlist	Public by default. Shows saved-but-unrated experiences. User can toggle private in settings.
Lists	User-curated collections of experiences (e.g. 'My Best Date Night Spots', 'Rainy Day Museums'). Shown as a grid of list covers on the profile. Tap through to the full list view.

Follow Model

One-way follow model (Instagram-style). Anyone can follow any public profile without approval. Following someone means their ratings appear in your feed. Users can set their profile to private in settings, requiring follower approval.

Settings

- Edit name, photo, handle, bio
- Re-take / update onboarding survey

- Toggle wishlist visibility (public / private)
- Toggle profile visibility (public / private)
- Manage email notification preferences
- Connected accounts (Google / Instagram)
- Log out / delete account

Lists

Concept

Lists are user-curated collections of experiences — the Spotify playlist equivalent for your life. Any rated or wishlisted experience can be added to a list. Lists are shareable, discoverable, and live on your profile. They are the highest expression of a user's taste and the most powerful organic sharing mechanic in the app.

> **What a List looks like**
> Example lists: 'Best date night spots in the West Village', 'NYC museums worth the line', 'My go-to pilates studios', 'Things to do in Brooklyn on a Sunday', 'Spots I'd take a visitor'. Lists make taste tangible and shareable.

Creating a List

Users can create a new list from three entry points:

- From their Profile — 'New List' button in the Lists section
- From a Listing Page — 'Add to List' option alongside 'Save to Wishlist'
- From their Ratings history — multi-select experiences and group into a new list

List creation flow:

Field	Description
List Name	Required. Max 60 characters. E.g. 'My Best Date Night Spots'.
Description	Optional. Max 160 characters. Gives the list context or a point of view.
Cover	Auto-generated from the first item's photo or emoji. User can swap to any item's photo or upload a custom image.
Visibility	Public (default) or Private. Public lists are discoverable via profile and shareable externally.
Experiences	Any rated or wishlisted experience can be added. No minimum; suggested minimum of 3 for sharing. Experiences are ordered manually by drag-and-drop.
Category tag	Auto-assigned from the dominant category of items in the list (e.g. 'Food & Drink', 'Mixed'). User can override.

List Detail Page

Each list has a full-page view:

- List name, description, creator avatar + handle, and category tag
- Cover image — full-bleed at top, fading into the list
- Item count and total Vouch Score average across all items in the list
- Ordered list of experiences — each showing name, category, the creator's personal Vouch Score in Brand Yellow, and a one-line excerpt of their review
- 'Follow this List' button — users can follow a list to get notified when items are added (post-MVP)
- Share button — opens the sharing sheet (see Section 8)
- 'Add to my Wishlist' shortcut — bulk-saves all list items

Lists on Profile

Lists appear on the profile page as a horizontal scrollable row of list cover cards. Each card shows the list name, item count, and cover image. Tapping opens the list detail page. Public lists are visible to anyone; private lists are visible only to the owner.

Lists in the Feed

When a user you follow creates or updates a public list, a feed card surfaces showing the list name, creator, item count, top 3 experience names, and a 'View List' CTA. This is one of the most shareable card types in the feed — lists signal taste at a higher level than individual ratings.

List Data Model

- list_id (Vouch UUID), name, description, creator_user_id
- visibility: public | private
- cover_image_url, category_tag
- items: [{ experience_id, order_index, added_at }]
- created_at, updated_at
- follower_count (post-MVP)

FEATURE — SHARING

Sharing

Concept

Sharing is the primary organic growth engine for Vouch. Every rating, listing, and list can be shared externally — outside the app — as a visually branded card. The goal is to make sharing a Vouch card feel as natural and desirable as sharing a Spotify playlist or a Letterboxd review: a piece of content that says something about who you are.

> **Growth Loop**
> Every share is also an acquisition touchpoint. Recipients who don't have Vouch see a landing page with the content and a clear CTA to sign up. The share card itself carries the Vouch brand.

What Can Be Shared

Shareable Object	Framing
A Rating	Your personal rating of an experience — your scores, review text, tags, and photo. Framed as 'I vouched for [Venue Name]'.
A Listing	The full Vouch listing for a venue or event — composite score, top reviews, friends' takes. Framed as 'Check out [Venue Name] on Vouch'.
A List	An entire user-curated list — cover image, list name, and top items. Framed as '[Your name]'s list: [List Name]'.
A Profile	Your public profile — handle, stats, top categories, and a preview of recent ratings. Framed as 'See my taste profile on Vouch'.

Share Card Design

When a user taps Share on any object, Vouch generates a branded visual card — a static image optimized for each destination format. The card design follows the Vouch visual identity:

- Background: warm off-white (#F5F5F3) or the cover photo with a dark overlay
- Vouch wordmark in the top-left corner (black Georgia serif + orange period)
- Score displayed large in Brand Yellow (#F5C842) — the visual centrepiece
- Experience name in Georgia serif, black

- User handle in Brand Orange, small
- One-line review excerpt or list description in gray body text
- Bottom strip: 'Find it on Vouch' with vouch.app URL — the acquisition hook

Share Destinations

Destination	Implementation
WhatsApp	Shares as a rich link with the Vouch card image as the preview thumbnail. Tapping the link opens the listing, list, or profile in the browser with a Vouch sign-up prompt for non-users.
Instagram Stories	Generates a 9:16 vertical card image (1080×1920px) optimized for Stories format. User is deep-linked into Instagram with the card pre-loaded as a Story sticker. They can add text, stickers, or reactions before posting.
Snapchat Stories	Generates a 9:16 vertical card. User is deep-linked into Snapchat with the card as a Snap. Uses Snapchat's Creative Kit SDK for the deep-link integration.
iMessage / SMS	Shares as a URL with rich link preview (Open Graph tags). The Vouch card image appears as the link preview in iMessage threads. Falls back to plain URL on SMS.
Copy Link	Copies the canonical Vouch URL for the object (e.g. vouch.app/list/[id]). Works for any other destination — email, Twitter/X, LinkedIn, etc.
Native Share Sheet	On mobile, 'More' opens the OS native share sheet (iOS Share Sheet / Android Sharesheet), giving access to any app installed on the device.

Share Card Formats

Format	Spec & Usage
Square (1:1)	Default format. Used for WhatsApp, iMessage previews, and copy link. 1080×1080px.
Vertical Story (9:16)	Instagram Stories and Snapchat. 1080×1920px. More immersive; shows cover image full-bleed with score and details overlaid.
Auto-select	The app detects the share destination and serves the correct format automatically. User can manually toggle format before sharing.

Share Card Generation

Share cards are server-side rendered images (using a headless browser or canvas API). Generated on-demand and cached per object. Key technical requirements:

- Server-side image generation — Puppeteer, Playwright, or Satori (React → SVG → PNG) recommended
- Open Graph tags on all public Vouch URLs so link previews render correctly on WhatsApp, iMessage, and Twitter/X
- Deep-link integration with Instagram (via Instagram Stories SDK) and Snapchat (via Creative Kit SDK)
- Fallback: if deep-link fails, user is given the image to save and share manually
- Cards cached for 24 hours per object; invalidated when the underlying data changes

Non-User Landing Page

When a non-user taps a shared Vouch link, they land on a lightweight public page showing the rated experience, list, or profile — with ratings and reviews visible without requiring login. A persistent bottom bar shows 'Join Vouch to rate your own experiences' with a sign-up CTA. This page is the primary acquisition surface from shares.

External Data Sources

Venue Data

Integration	Role
Google Places API	Primary. Venue name, address, category, hours, photos, coordinates. Covers restaurants, bars, gyms, museums, and all permanent venues.
Yelp Fusion API	Supplementary venue data and category taxonomy for gap-filling.
Foursquare Places API	Tertiary, particularly strong for nightlife and niche activity venues.

Event Data

Integration	Role
Eventbrite API	Live events, cultural experiences, fitness classes, workshops. Provides event name, date, time, venue, ticket URL, category.
Ticketmaster Discovery API	Concerts, sports games, theater, live entertainment. Provides event details, artist/team info, and ticket purchase URLs.
Resident Advisor (RA) API	Electronic music, club nights, DJ sets. Key for nightlife discovery in NYC.
NYC Open Data	City-run events, free concerts, parks programming. Covers free experiences not on ticketing platforms.
SeatGeek API	Supplementary ticket data for sports and live events; aggregates pricing across resellers.

Data Model — Experience Object

All venues and events share a unified Experience object regardless of source:

- experience_id (Vouch UUID), name, category, subcategory
- type: venue | event
- location: address, neighborhood, lat/lng
- external_ids: { google_place_id, eventbrite_id, ticketmaster_id, ra_id }

- event_date, event_end_date (null for permanent venues)
- ticket_url (null for venues)
- vouch_score: { vibe_avg, value_avg, experience_avg, composite, rating_count }
- photos: [ ], tags: [ ]

RE-ENGAGEMENT

Email Strategy

Vouch does not ship in-app push notifications in the MVP. Email is the primary re-engagement channel, designed to build a return-visit habit and keep the social loop active.

Friend Activity Email

Attribute	Detail
Trigger	A friend you follow submits a new rating
Frequency	Batched — max 1 digest email per day per user, even if multiple friends rate that day
Subject line	"[Friend name] vouched for [Venue Name]"
Body	Friend avatar + name, experience name, Vouch Score (large, Brand Yellow in email design), score breakdown, review text, photo if available, and a CTA button to view the listing
Goal	Drive same-day return visits by making friend activity feel immediate and relevant

Weekly Trending Digest

Attribute	Detail
Trigger	Scheduled — every Thursday at 10am ET
Audience	All users who completed onboarding
Subject line	"What NYC is vouching for this week"
Body	5–7 trending experiences in NYC filtered to the user's survey categories. Each item shows name, Vouch Score, top tag. One editorial 'Vouch Staff Pick' per email.
Personalization	Category filter from onboarding survey. For users with 5+ ratings, also factor in their rating history.
Goal	Weekly habit formation and re-engagement for lapsed users

Opt-Out Policy

> Both email types are opt-in by default at sign-up. Users can manage preferences individually from profile settings. Every email must include a one-click unsubscribe link (CAN-SPAM compliance).

TECHNICAL

Technical Considerations

Platform

Vouch MVP is a mobile-first web application. No native iOS or Android app is required for launch. The web app must be fully functional on mobile browsers (Safari on iOS, Chrome on Android). A desktop breakpoint is a nice-to-have, not a requirement.

Key Technical Requirements

Area	Approach
Auth	OAuth 2.0 via Google and Instagram. JWT session management. No password storage.
Database	PostgreSQL for users, ratings, follows, wishlists, lists, comments, streaks, Side Quests. Search-optimized index for experience lookup.
Search	Full-text search across experience names + categories. Algolia or Elasticsearch recommended.
Feed Algorithm	Server-side ranked feed. Blend of friend activity recency, trending score, and category affinity. Recalculated on load — no real-time push in MVP.
Map	Mapbox or Google Maps JS API for the Map tab. Clustered pin rendering for performance. Layer toggling (My Ratings / Friends / Wishlist) handled client-side.
Voice Input	Web Speech API (browser-native) for voice capture on the Discover Bar. Fallback: standard text input. Whisper API (OpenAI) as upgrade path for accuracy improvement post-launch.
AI / LLM	OpenAI or Anthropic Claude API for Discover Bar intent parsing and recommendation generation. Prompt templates maintained by engineering; content guardrails set by editorial team. Responses cached where intent is identical. Cost monitored per query.
Image Storage	User-uploaded photos in S3-compatible object storage. CDN-served. Max 3 photos per rating, 5MB per photo.
Share Card Generation	Server-side image rendering via Satori (React → SVG → PNG) or Puppeteer. Cards cached 24hrs per object. Open Graph tags on all public URLs.

Gamification	Streak tracking via daily cron job. Leaderboard computed weekly via scheduled job. Side Quest completion tracked against rating submissions. Wrapped cards generated via scheduled job (1st of month; December annual).
Email	Transactional and batch email via SendGrid or Postmark. Streak nudge, Side Quest reminder, and Wrapped announcement emails added to existing queue.
API Caching	All third-party API calls aggressively cached. Venue data refreshed daily; event data every 6 hours. LLM responses cached by intent hash.
Analytics	Mixpanel or Amplitude. Key events: sign_up, survey_complete, rating_submitted, wishlist_save, feed_item_click, discover_bar_query, map_neighbourhood_opened, side_quest_started, side_quest_completed, streak_broken, wrapped_viewed, wrapped_shared, share_tapped, email_open, email_click.

SUCCESS METRICS

MVP Success Metrics

North Star

> **North Star Metric**
> Weekly Active Raters — the number of unique users who submit at least one rating per week. This captures both retention and the core value loop: rate → friend sees → friend uses → friend rates.

Supporting Metrics

Metric	Definition & Target
Activation Rate	% of sign-ups who complete survey + submit first rating within 7 days. Target: >60%.
Ratings per User / Week	Average ratings per weekly active user. Target: >2.
Feed Click-Through Rate	% of feed cards resulting in a listing page tap-through. Target: >15%.
Wishlist Save Rate	% of listing page views resulting in a wishlist save. Target: >10%.
Email Open Rate	Friend Activity: target >40%. Weekly Digest: target >30%.
Email-Driven Return Rate	% of email recipients who open the app within 48hrs. Target: >20%.
Follow Graph Density	Average follows per user at 30 days. Target: >8. Below this, social feed is too sparse to deliver value.
Lists Created per User	Average lists created per user in first 30 days. Target: >1. A user who creates a list is significantly more retained.
Share Rate	% of listing page and list detail page views that result in an external share. Target: >5%. Each share is a potential acquisition touchpoint.
Share-Driven Sign-ups	% of new sign-ups that arrive via a shared Vouch link. Track via UTM parameters on all share URLs. Target: >15% of total sign-ups within 60 days of launch.

COMPLETE FEATURE UNIVERSE

Full Feature List

This section captures the complete agreed feature set for Vouch across all product surfaces. Features are not yet prioritised for MVP vs. post-MVP — that scoping exercise follows. This is the full picture of what Vouch is.

Navigation

Vouch uses a 4-tab persistent bottom navigation bar on mobile:

Tab	Purpose
Feed	Home screen. Friend activity, Vouch Picks, trending, upcoming events. Discover bar pinned at the top for voice/text intent search.
Search	Universal search across all venues and events. Rate, log, tag friends. Browse by category tabs.
Map	NYC map view. Ratings, wishlists, friend activity plotted as pins. Neighbourhood Guide layer. Filter by category.
Profile	Public identity. Ratings, lists, wishlist, taste stats, streaks, followers/following.

1. Rating System

Feature	Description
Vibe / Value / Experience	Three-dimensional scoring on a 1–10 scale each. Composite Vouch Score = average of three, displayed in Brand Yellow.
Photos	Up to 3 photos per rating, max 5MB each.
Written review	Optional, max 280 characters. Concise and punchy.
Tags	Curated multi-select tag bank (e.g. 'Worth the hype', 'Great for dates', 'Hidden gem', 'Bring cash', 'Book ahead').
Visit date	Auto-populated to today; adjustable for retroactive logging.
Tag-a-friend	Tag up to 5 people you went with. They receive an email nudge and can add their own rating to the same experience. Drives network growth.

Comments	Friends can comment on any rating. Threaded. Drives conversation inside the app.
Score labels	Auto-assigned label based on composite score: 0–4 AVOID · 5–6 MEH · 7–8 RELIABLE · 9 GREAT · 10 TELL EVERYONE.

2. Feed

Feature	Description
Friend Activity Cards	When someone you follow rates, their card surfaces — score, breakdown, review, photos, tags.
Vouch Picks	Algorithmic recommendations based on survey + rating history. Clearly labelled.
Trending in NYC	High-velocity experiences gaining ratings this week across the full network.
Upcoming Event Cards	Time-sensitive events surfaced ahead of date with 'I'm Going' button and ticket link.
Wishlist Nudge Cards	When a friend rates something on your wishlist, that card is promoted to the top of feed.
List Cards	When a friend creates or updates a public list, a card surfaces with the list preview.
Category filter strip	Horizontal chip strip at top of feed to filter by category. Stateless — resets on exit.
Discover Bar	Pinned at the very top of the Feed. Voice-first input (typing fallback). Opens the AI recommendation engine.

3. Discover Bar — 'What do you want to do today?'

The Discover Bar is a conversational AI recommendation surface pinned at the top of the Feed. It is Vouch's answer to the blank-mind problem — when you know you want to do something but don't know where to start.

Attribute	Detail
Input	Voice-first. User taps the bar and speaks naturally: 'I want to plan something active for tonight in Brooklyn' or 'romantic dinner under $80 in the West Village'. Typing is the fallback — same interface, keyboard instead of mic.

Intent parsing	The AI parses: activity type, time of day / day of week, neighborhood or area, budget signals, group size signals, vibe (active, chill, romantic, social, solo).
Output	3–5 ranked recommendations returned as cards — each showing venue/event name, category, Vouch Score, a one-line reason ('Because you rated Pilates Plus 9/10'), and a CTA to view the listing.
Personalisation	Fully personalised from day one. Uses the user's taste profile (survey), rating history (Vibe/Value/Experience patterns), wishlist, and friend activity to weight recommendations.
AI model	LLM-powered intent parsing + recommendation ranking. Calls Vouch's own experience database and external integrations (Google Places, Eventbrite etc.) to source candidates.
Editorial gate	Before any AI-generated recommendation type goes live to all users, it must be reviewed and approved by the Vouch editorial team. The team defines content guardrails; AI operates within them. Individual outputs are spot-checked; category-level guardrails are set editorially.
Fallback	If the AI cannot confidently parse intent or finds fewer than 3 relevant results, it surfaces a generic 'Top picks for tonight in NYC' editorial set.
History	Previous Discover queries are saved in the user's session. They can tap back to a prior query to re-run it.

4. Search & Rate

Feature	Description
Universal search	Searches across all venues and events simultaneously. Two result tabs: Places and Events.
Result cards	Name, category, neighborhood, Vouch Score, friend avatars who've rated it.
Listing page	Full page per venue/event: Vouch Score (large, Brand Yellow), score breakdown, Friends' Takes section, All Reviews, upcoming event details, Log Your Visit CTA, Save to Wishlist, 'I'm Going' button for events.
'I'm Going'	For upcoming events, users can tap 'I'm Going' before the event. Their avatar appears on the listing page under 'Who's Going'. Friends see this in the feed. Creates a light social planning layer.

Log Your Visit	Opens rating modal from any listing page. Pre-fills the experience name.

5. Map

The Map is the spatial discovery surface — the NYC view of all Vouch data. It has three overlapping layers the user can toggle:

Feature	Description
My Ratings layer	Pins showing everywhere the user has rated, colour-coded by Vouch Score (yellow = high, gray = low). Tap a pin to see the rating card.
Friends layer	Pins showing where friends have rated. Tap to see who rated it and their score.
Wishlist layer	Saved-but-unvisited experiences shown as bookmark pins.
Neighbourhood Guides	Tap any NYC neighbourhood on the map (or type it into the map search bar) to open that neighbourhood's Guide — a curated page of the top-Vouched experiences in that area, organised by category. Cold start: populated by editorial + integration data (Google Places, Eventbrite). As user data grows, community Vouch Scores take precedence.
Category filter	Chip strip at top of map to filter all layers by category (Food, Events, Fitness, etc.).
Map search bar	Type a neighbourhood name, landmark, or address to navigate the map. Tapping a neighbourhood name surfaces the Neighbourhood Guide.

6. Lists

Feature	Description
Creation	Create from Profile, from any listing page ('Add to List'), or from Ratings history (multi-select).
Fields	Name (max 60 chars), description (max 160 chars), cover image, visibility (public/private), category tag.
Ordering	Manual drag-to-reorder. No algorithmic sorting within a list.

List Detail Page	Cover image, name, creator, item count, avg Vouch Score across items, ordered experience list with personal scores, Share button, 'Add all to Wishlist' shortcut.
Feed card	List creation/update surfaces as a feed card showing list name, top 3 items, creator, and 'View List' CTA.
Profile display	Lists shown as a horizontal scrollable grid of cover cards on the user's profile.

7. Social Graph & Network

Feature	Description
Follow model	One-way Instagram-style. Anyone can follow any public profile without approval.
Taste Compatibility Score	Shown on any friend's profile — a % match calculated from overlapping ratings across shared categories. E.g. '84% compatible'. Answers 'who should I bring to this?' and makes profiles stickier. Updates dynamically as both users rate more.
Tag-a-friend	On any rating, tag up to 5 people you went with. They're notified and can add their own rating.
Comments	Threaded comments on any rating. Friends only (not public). Drives in-app conversation.
'Who's Going'	On event listing pages, shows avatars of followers who've tapped 'I'm Going'. Social proof for upcoming events.

8. Gamification & Retention

Feature	Description
Streaks	Rate at least one experience per week to maintain your streak. Shown on profile with a flame icon. Broken streak resets to zero — creates urgency to rate. Email nudge sent if streak is at risk (6 days without rating).
NYC Leaderboard	City-wide ranking of most active Vouchers, updated weekly. Ranked by total ratings submitted in the last 30 days. Shown on Profile and as a browsable page. Top 10 get a 'Top Voucher' badge on their profile.
Side Quests	Editorially curated, time-limited challenges. E.g. 'The West Village Weekend — visit and rate 5 spots from this list by

	Sunday.' Created and managed by the Vouch editorial team. Users can see active Side Quests from their Profile and the Feed. Completing a Side Quest earns a badge and a shareable completion card.
Vouch Wrapped — Monthly	A shareable visual card generated on the 1st of each month. Shows: experiences rated, top category, highest-rated moment, most-visited neighborhood, streak record. Fully shareable via the standard share sheet (Instagram Stories, WhatsApp, etc.).
Vouch Wrapped — Annual	A richer annual version in December. Adds: total experiences across the year, new categories explored, compatibility with top friends, a 'Your Year in Experiences' headline stat. Designed to go viral — the shareable card is the primary acquisition mechanic of the year.

9. Sharing

Feature	Description
Shareable objects	Any rating, listing, list, or profile can be shared externally.
Share card formats	Square (1:1, 1080×1080px) for WhatsApp and iMessage. Vertical Story (9:16, 1080×1920px) for Instagram Stories and Snapchat. Auto-detected by destination.
Destinations	WhatsApp (rich link + card thumbnail) · Instagram Stories (deep-link via Stories SDK) · Snapchat (deep-link via Creative Kit SDK) · iMessage/SMS (Open Graph rich preview) · Copy Link · Native OS share sheet.
Card design	Off-white (#F5F5F3) background. Score in Brand Yellow at large size. Vouch wordmark top-left. Experience name in Georgia serif. 'Find it on Vouch' acquisition footer.
Non-user landing	Shared links open a public page showing the content with full ratings visible. Persistent bottom bar: 'Join Vouch to rate your own experiences' CTA.
Server-side generation	Cards generated server-side (Satori or Puppeteer). Cached 24hrs per object.

10. Profile

Feature	Description

Public elements	Name, photo, handle (@username), bio (120 chars), stats bar (rated · categories · member since), followers/following, Taste Compatibility Score (on others' profiles), Top Categories, Recent Ratings grid, Lists, Wishlist, Streak, Leaderboard rank.
Wishlist	Public by default. Saved-but-unrated experiences. Toggleable to private.
Settings	Edit profile, re-take survey, manage email prefs, toggle visibility, connected accounts, log out / delete.

11. Email & Re-engagement

Feature	Description
Friend Activity Digest	Batched daily. Max 1 email per user per day. Triggered by friends' new ratings.
Weekly Trending Digest	Every Thursday 10am ET. 5–7 trending NYC experiences filtered to user's survey categories. One editorial Staff Pick per email.
Streak at-risk nudge	Sent on day 6 without a rating if user has an active streak. Short, punchy: 'Your streak is at risk — rate one thing before midnight.'
Side Quest reminder	Sent 24hrs before a Side Quest deadline to users who started but haven't completed it.
Wrapped announcement	Monthly and annual Wrapped cards announced via email with a 'See your Wrapped' CTA.

12. External Integrations

Integration	Role
Google Places API	Primary venue data source — name, address, category, hours, photos, coordinates.
Yelp Fusion API	Supplementary venue data and category taxonomy.
Foursquare Places API	Tertiary, strong for nightlife and niche activity venues.
Eventbrite API	Live events, cultural experiences, fitness classes, workshops.
Ticketmaster Discovery API	Concerts, sports, theater. Ticket purchase URLs.

Resident Advisor API	Electronic music, club nights, DJ sets.
NYC Open Data	Free city-run events, parks programming, cultural events.
SeatGeek API	Supplementary ticket pricing and sports/live event data.
LLM API	Powers the Discover Bar intent parsing and recommendation ranking. OpenAI or Anthropic Claude API. Calls Vouch's experience database + external APIs to source recommendation candidates.

SCOPE BOUNDARIES

Out of Scope — MVP

The following are intentionally deferred and not in scope for the initial launch:

- Native iOS or Android applications
- In-app push notifications
- Monetization — promoted listings, affiliate ticket links, brand partnerships
- Geographic expansion beyond New York City
- Direct messaging between users
- Group wishlists or collaborative planning
- Business / venue owner dashboard or claimed listings
- List following / notifications when a followed list is updated
- Event creation / hosting (Partiful-style) — Vouch is a discovery and rating app, not an event planning tool
- Verified accounts or creator program
- Dark mode

OPEN QUESTIONS

Open Questions

Question	Notes
Content moderation	Policy for offensive, fake, or spam reviews? Manual review vs. automated flagging?
Rating edit / delete	Can users edit or delete their ratings after submission? Time window?
Category taxonomy	Final list of categories and subcategories needs to be locked before development begins.
Tag bank	Complete set of user-selectable tags needs to be defined to balance optionality vs. decision fatigue.
Friend suggestions	Should Vouch suggest accounts to follow via mutual contacts or contact import? Privacy implications to resolve.
Instagram API scope	Instagram's Basic Display API has post-2024 limitations. Confirm accessible user data fields under current terms.

Recurring events	How are recurring events handled — as one listing or separate dated entries per occurrence?
Score display on low count	What is the minimum rating count before a composite Vouch Score is displayed publicly? Suggest threshold of 3.
Instagram Stories SDK	Requires app review for deep-link access. Confirm approval timeline and fallback UX if rejected.
Snapchat Creative Kit	Requires developer registration and review. Confirm availability and whether manual save-and-share fallback is sufficient for MVP.
Share card branding	Personal framing (user's name/avatar) vs. platform framing (Vouch brand only)?
List minimum items	Minimum item count before a list can be public or shared? Suggest 3.
Discover Bar — LLM provider	OpenAI vs. Anthropic Claude API vs. other. Consider latency, cost per query, and content moderation built-in tools.
Discover Bar — voice API	Web Speech API (browser-native, free) vs. Whisper (OpenAI, more accurate). Confirm browser compatibility on mobile Safari and Chrome Android.
Discover Bar — editorial guardrails	What content guardrails does the editorial team set before AI goes live? Categories to exclude? Price thresholds? Minimum Vouch Score?
Compatibility Score algorithm	How is Taste Compatibility calculated when two users have few overlapping ratings? Minimum overlap threshold before displaying a score?
Leaderboard fairness	How to prevent leaderboard gaming — users submitting low-effort ratings to climb the board? Minimum rating length or photo requirement for leaderboard eligibility?
Side Quest cadence	How frequently does the editorial team publish new Side Quests? Weekly? Bi-weekly? What is the workflow for creation, review, and scheduling?
Neighbourhood Guide threshold	At what point does a Neighbourhood Guide transition from editorial + integration data to community Vouch data as the primary source? Suggest 20+ ratings per neighborhood.